afforded to raise the entire capital. Rs 10 lakh was a steep price. Shipping was a big business involving lakhs of rupees, and the company had perforce to cast its net wide to draw shareholders. There were prominent personalities from outside the Tirunelveli region who invested in SSNCo.

The response from Madras City was, surprisingly, disappointing. According to the Madras agent of SSNCo, 'it is very difficult to make the people of Madras understand and realize the advantages of Swadeshi enterprise and he was not able to collect more shares in Madras, though Calcutta contributed 15,000 and Bombay 10,000 shares'. However, once the company's own steamers reached Madras harbour the scene would change, he believed.[62] The numbers regarding Calcutta and Bombay seem fanciful.

From police reports we gather the following about investors from the city of Madras: Lodd Govindas, a Gujarati businessman and philanthropist with moderate nationalist leanings, took a respectable 120 shares—enough to qualify him for a directorship, though he did not exercise this option. While V. Krishnaswamy Aiyar, eminent Moderate personality, legal luminary and promoter of the Indian Bank, took a disappointingly low number of shares (just twenty-five), his fellow lawyer and friend P.R. Sundara Aiyar took even less: only twelve shares. To give the benefit of doubt to him, the launching of the Indian Bank had probably exhausted his resources, and Krishnaswamy Aiyar may have decided to be more prudent. Or, more likely, he may have been somewhat annoyed with VOC for publicly voicing his impatience with the delay in the formation of the Indian Bank.[63]

If G. Subramania Iyer subscribed to only five shares it was quite understandable: he was only a journalist with a modest income. Though, clearly, he was backing his impassioned words in *Swadesamitran* with his wallet.[64]

Overall, *The Hindu* complained that Madras City was tepid in its response claiming that in all twenty-seven people contributed towards only 228 shares—most likely an underestimate.[65]

Madras City apart, investors came from the hinterland as well. Largely due to the initiative of C. Vijayaraghavachari, it would appear, there were